

From idea to measured value.

Build Lab is a shared home for AI ideas. It gives us a simple way to capture them, evaluate them the same way every time, and follow what gets built. It works alongside the processes our teams already use.

A short tour for new users · August 2026 · [build-lab.dev](#)

Data informs. Scoring creates consistency. Humans decide.

Submit → Triage → Score → Rank → Governance → Build → Measure

One pipeline, five stages.

An idea takes the same path whether it comes from a portfolio company or our own team. Build Lab keeps the record along the way: what came in, what we decided, and what it returned. Good ideas don't get lost, and results are easy to show.

01

Submit

Anyone submits an idea in about five minutes. No login needed.

02

Score

AI drafts a first pass against a five-part rubric. The triage team reviews and adjusts.

03

Decide

Governance reviews the ranked list and decides what we pursue. People make the call, not the algorithm.

04

Build

Approved work becomes a project with phases, owners, and a target date.

05

Measure

Each project keeps its success metrics. Estimates are never reported as results.

Scoring weighs the opportunity itself: impact, speed to something usable, data feasibility, sponsorship, and repeatability. For portfolio company ideas it also weighs **where we have the most capital at work and the longest runway**. A strong idea at a company we just backed outranks the same idea at one nearing exit.

Three things to try on your first visit

- 1 Submit an idea.** Go to build-lab.dev/submit and put in a real opportunity you've been thinking about. It takes about five minutes and saves as you go. (Page 3)
- 2 Open a live project.** Sign in, open **Projects**, and click into one. You'll see where it stands, what's next, and what's blocked without having to ask anyone. (Page 4)
- 3 Look at Analytics.** It shows what's coming in, what we approved, how fast things move, and what has actually been measured. (Page 5)

The intake form: five minutes, no login.

Anyone on our team, or at a portfolio company, can submit at build-lab.dev/submit. The form adapts to the type of request and saves automatically as you type. "Unknown" is always an acceptable answer. Don't let a missing detail stop a good idea.

Submit an AI Initiative
Takes about 5-7 minutes if you know the opportunity well. Your answers save automatically — keep this page's link if you want to finish later.

What kind of request is this?

Specialist — Specialist Build
An Internal Specialist requests an AI capability for a Specialist workflow.

Specialist — Portfolio Company Build
An Internal Specialist submits or sponsors an AI opportunity involving a portfolio company.

Generalist — Portfolio Company Build
An Internal Generalist submits or sponsors an AI opportunity involving a portfolio company.

STEP 1 · BASICS

Who you are and a name for the idea. Portfolio company requests also ask **which company, which function, and who is sponsoring it** internally.

STEP 3 · THE ASK

What you actually want AI to do: the task itself, not just "use AI." Also **what success looks like 90 days after launch**, and any metrics that exist today.

STEP 5 · PRIORITY SIGNAL

If you could fund only one AI initiative this quarter, is this it? Any deadline or forcing event, and **who owns the business outcome**.

The Ask
Step 3 of 6

What do you want AI to actually do?
Describe the task itself, not just "use AI." Example: "Create first-pass PMC decks using CRM, customer usage, and support data."

What would success look like 90 days after this ships?

What metrics exist today?
Add metric ☐ No meaningful baseline exists today

What value does this create?

☐ Revenue ☐ Cost ☐ Margin
☐ Productivity ☐ Customer Experience ☐ Quality
☐ Risk ☐ Speed ☐ Strategic Capability
☐ Other

How, specifically?

Requester effort estimate
Your rough sense — triage will make the final call.

☐ Small
Days of work — a focused tool or automation touching one workflow.

☐ Medium

STEP 2 · BUSINESS PROBLEM

What process or challenge you want to address, **how it works today** (who does it, what tools, how often, how long), and who or what is affected.

STEP 4 · FEASIBILITY

What data and systems are involved, whether anyone has tried before, and your honest guess at **how fast something usable could exist**.

STEP 6 · REVIEW & SUBMIT

One screen showing everything, with edit shortcuts. After submitting, the link becomes a **status page** you can check anytime.

Projects: what we're building, at a glance.

When governance approves an initiative, it becomes a project with a lead, a target date, and a ten-phase path from Discovery to Complete. The overview answers the questions you would normally have to ask in a meeting, and the red stripe means the same thing on every project.

The screenshot shows the BCP Build Lab interface. On the left is a dark blue sidebar with navigation links: Build Lab, me, TAKE, Commit Initiative, Initiatives, INITIATIVES, Initiatives, AGE, Age Queue, GVERNANCE, Governance Queue, Portfolio Ranking, IVERY, Rapid Deployment, External FDE Pod, ire Transformation, Waiting Capacity, PROJECTS, Projects (highlighted), IIGHTS, Analytics, MAIN, ers, and Meta-Composi...

The main content area has a search bar and links for Notifications, Alex Admin, and Sign out. The project title is "FP&A variance narrative drafts" with a yellow status indicator. Below the title, key information is displayed: Company (Cobalt Health Partners), Function (Finance), Lane (Rapid Deployment), Lead (Sofia Rossi), Business owner (Dana Wu), and Target deployment (Sep 5, 2026).

A phase rail shows the project's progress through ten phases: Discovery, Solution Design, Data / Access, Build, QA, User Testing (current phase, dark blue), Pilot, Production, Measurement, and Complete. A red stripe highlights the current phase.

Below the phase rail, there are tabs for Overview, Tasks (3), Updates (1), KPIs, and Activity. The Overview tab is selected.

The Outcome section states: "Draft variance narratives from GL exports and budget files for analyst review. Success: Narratives drafted within 4 hours of close; analysts edit rather than write."

The CURRENT STATUS section shows: "Narrative quality sign-off from two analysts on July data. Sofia Rossi · about 1 hour ago".

The NEXT MILESTONE section shows: "Dry run on August close — Aug 15, 2026".

The Blockers section shows: "August close dry run — Waiting on Cobalt IT to whitelist the export service account."

The Recent activity section shows three entries: "Aug 13, 8:33 PM Health GREEN → YELLOW: Dry run blocked on Cobalt IT service-account approval — 5 days waiting.", "Aug 13, 8:33 PM Phase → User Testing", and "Aug 13, 8:33 PM Project started".

The phase rail shows exactly where it stands

Discovery through Build, Pilot, Production, and Measurement. Green is done, dark is where it stands today.

Blockers surface themselves

Anything stuck appears on the project, the delivery dashboard, and the home page, so nobody has to chase it.

Health is honest by design

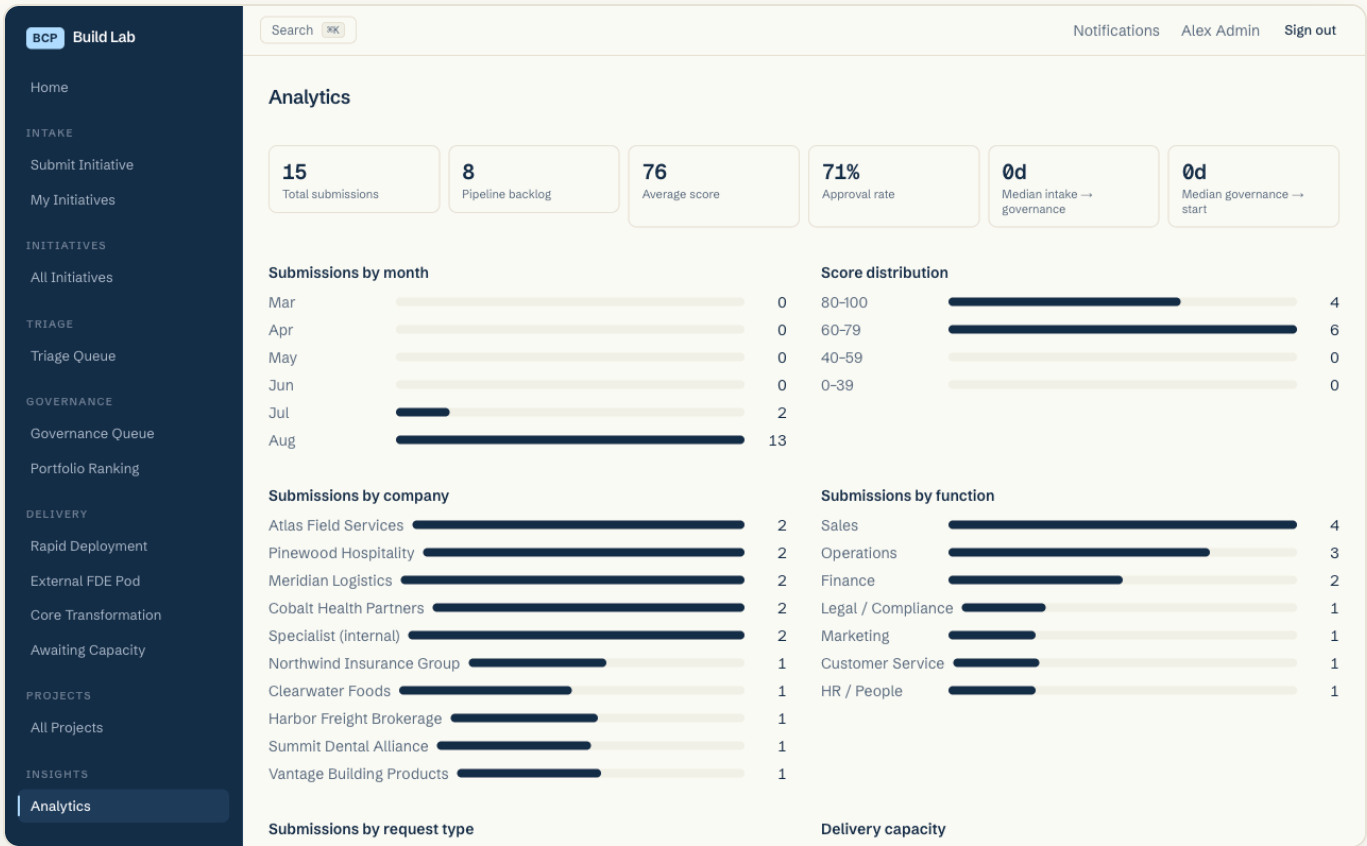
Green, yellow, or red. Yellow or red always comes with a written reason.

Every project keeps its "why"

One click back to the original initiative: the problem, the scores, and the governance decision that approved it.

Analytics: everything in flight, on one page.

For everything running through Build Lab: where ideas come from, how they score, what gets approved, and how fast things move from intake to build. The table that matters most is **validated value**. It only admits measured outcomes, never projections. If it's in that table, it happened.



Getting started

Darren will send your sign-in credentials separately. Submitting an idea never requires an account, so the submit link can be shared freely.

build-lab.dev
build-lab.dev/submit